Development of foetus occurs inside the uterus. The narrower lower part of uterus is called **cervix**, which leads into vagina.

Vagina: The uterus narrows down into a hollow muscular tube called vagina. It connects cervix and the external genitalia. It receives the sperms, acts as birth canal during child birth (**parturition**).

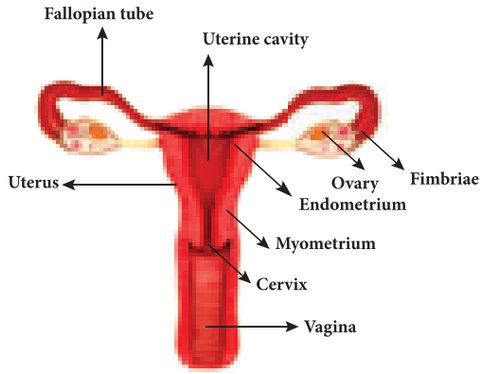


Figure 20.9 Female reproductive system

More to Know

An ovum is the largest human cell. The process of formation of ova is known as **oogenesis.**

Points to Remember

- All the organ systems work together in coordination to maintain the body in a homeostatic condition of an organism.
- Alimentary canal consists of mouth, buccal cavity, pharynx, oesophagus, stomach, small intestine (consisting of duodenum, jejunum and ileum), large intestine (consisting of caecum, colon and rectum) and anus.
- The five stages of nutrition process include ingestion, digestion, absorption, assimilation and egestion.
- The small intestine serves both for digestion and absorption.
- The human excretory system consists of a pair of kidney, which produce the urine.
- The process of urine formation includes the following three stages: Glomerular filtration, tubular reabsorption and tubular secretion.
- The reproductive organ of male is testis and female is ovary which are distinguished as primary sex organs.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Emulsification	Conversion of large fat droplets into smaller ones.
Enzymes	Substances produced by living organisms which acts as a catalyst to bring about specific biochemical reactions.
Homeostasis	Tendency of the body to seek and maintain a balance condition or equilibrium within its internal environment.
Mastication (Chewing)	Process by which food is crushed and ground by teeth.
Metabolism	Sum total of all chemical and energy changes taking place in an organism.
Osmoregulation	Maintenance of constant osmotic pressure in the fluids of an organism by the control of water and salt concentration.
Regurgitation	Act of bringing swallowed food back into the mouth.
Toxic substance	Substances that can be poisonous or cause health effects to living organisms.

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